Margin Material

Q4 Action Plan: Oct 12 - Dec 31, 2026

Daily, weekly and monthly actions to reach the $500-$600 quarterly goal across vintage reselling, custom dressmaking and personal styling.

1. The Big Picture

Goal	Target	Deadline	Revenue
1. Vintage (Depop)	10 sales per month	Every month (Oct, Nov, Dec)	$200+ (about $20 average per sale)
2. Custom dressmaking	First clients secured (3 clients/orders)	Dec 1 (Tuesday)	$300+ (about $100 per piece)
3. Personal styling	1 paying client	Dec 31	$150+
Total			$650 if all three hit; $500-$600 goal gives a cushion

- **Assumptions I made (please correct if wrong):** the $200 is total vintage revenue (not per month); the dressmaking goal reads as 3 clients/orders for $300 total by Dec 1; sunglasses (launching June 2027) are parked and only appear as a teaser on Instagram.
- **Time needed:** about 60-90 minutes per day, 6 days a week, plus one 2-hour weekly block. Adjust to her schedule; the weekly tasks matter more than doing every daily task perfectly.
- **Why this works:** only one thing has to go right per goal. Vintage needs steady listings and sharing; dressmaking and styling need direct conversations with people who already know her. Most first clients come from personal outreach, not strangers on social media.
- **Fees note:** check Depop's current seller and payment-processing fees and price items so that $200 revenue leaves real profit. Also track what she paid for each item. Holiday shipping deadlines change yearly, so confirm them before December.

2. The Daily Routine (60-90 minutes)

Block	Time	What to do
A. Depop	20 min	List 1 new item OR improve 1 old listing (better photos, title, tags). Refresh/relist a stale item. Reply to every message and offer within a few hours.
B. Depop outreach	10 min	Send a bundle offer or discount (via Depop offers) to 5 people who liked an item. Like/follow 10 accounts that buy her style (vintage lovers, local shoppers).
C. Instagram post	20 min	Post 1 item that day: a Reel, carousel or Story (see content calendar). Always include a call to action (DM 'DRESS' / 'STYLE' / link in bio to Depop).
D. Engage	15 min	Comment meaningfully on 10 posts from local people, small brands, brides, event goers. Reply to every comment and DM.
E. Client outreach	15 min	Message 3 people about a service (dress, alteration, styling). Follow up with anyone who replied. Log everything in the tracker.

Block	Time	What to do
F. Close the day	5 min	Write down: listings added, sales, messages sent, leads. Pick tomorrow's item to photograph.

Daily minimums on a busy day (15 minutes)

- Reply to all messages.
- Send 3 outreach messages (1 each for dress, styling, and a Depop liker).
- Post one Story.

3. The Weekly Rhythm

Day	Focus	Key tasks
Monday	Plan + sourcing	Review last week's numbers. Plan 5 posts. Sourcing trip (thrift, estate sales, Goodwill bins, Facebook Marketplace) - buy 5-10 pieces she'd wear herself.
Tuesday	Photo + list day	Wash/steam/measure items. Shoot all photos in natural light. List 5-7 items (do this block once a week to save time).
Wednesday	Dressmaking day	Post sketches, fabric, process. Message 5 warm leads about custom dress (friends, family, coworkers, past buyers).
Thursday	Styling day	Post a styling tip (Reel). DM 5 people about the styling session. Offer a free 10-minute mini consult to start conversations.
Friday	Vintage push	Feature 3 best items on Stories. Bundle deal ('buy 2 save 15%'). Re-share to Instagram.
Saturday	Content batch	2 hours: film next week's Reels and write captions. Local markets/pop-up if available.
Sunday	Review (20 min)	Fill out scorecard (section 8). Husband helps: photos, packing, outreach lists.

4. Monthly Milestones

Phase 1: Oct 12 - Oct 31 (Launch + first sales)

- [ ] Depop: 25+ active listings by Oct 31; 6+ sales (stretch: 10).
- [ ] Rewrite all Depop and Instagram bios: 'Vintage finds + custom dresses + personal styling.'
- [ ] Create a simple price menu: dress commissions, alterations, 1 styling package.
- [ ] Photograph 3-5 pieces she's already made (or make one quick sample dress) for a portfolio highlight on Instagram.
- [ ] Message 30 personal contacts about the dress offer and styling session (a text, not a mass post).
- [ ] Offer a launch special: first 3 dress clients get a small perk (free hem or fabric choice help). First styling client gets a bonus.

Phase 2: November (Momentum + deadlines)

- [ ] Depop: 10 sales. Add holiday-ready items (coats, knits, party dresses, gift-sized accessories) and post a 'Holiday gift' Story series.
- [ ] Dressmaking: post 'Order by Nov 20 for holiday/NYE delivery' - real deadline creates urgency. Book at least 2 consults.

[ ] Secure the first dress client by Nov 15, all 3 by Dec 1 (even if one is a smaller alteration/mending job - it still counts toward $300 if she prices fairly).
[ ] Styling: run 1 free mini consult or Instagram 'style a look' giveaway to generate 3-5 qualified leads.
[ ] Collect testimonials / photos from every buyer and client.

Phase 3: December (Close it out)

[ ] Dec 1: dress clients locked in with deposits (suggest 50%).
[ ] Depop: 10 sales. Run a 'last shipping day' push (check Depop/USPS holiday cutoffs) and a Dec 26-31 sale.
[ ] Styling: close 1 client by Dec 31. Pitch: 'New year, new closet' - perfect timing for resolutions.
[ ] Deliver dresses early and request reviews and Instagram tags.
[ ] Dec 28-31: final scorecard + plan for Q1 (including sunglasses teaser).

Revenue pacing (if all goes to plan)

Date	Vintage	Dress	Styling	Running total
Oct 31	$120	$0 (leads + 1 deposit)	$0	$120
Nov 30	$200 cumulative	$150-$200	$0 (booked)	$350-$400
Dec 31	$300 (all Q4)	$300	$150	$650+

5. Goal-by-Goal Playbooks

Goal 1: Vintage - 10 sales a month on Depop

- **Photos:** natural light, plain background, 5+ photos per item (front, back, tag, detail, flaw if any, and worn/on a mannequin). Worn photos sell best on Depop.
- **Titles:** include era, brand, item and size: 'Vintage 90s black wool blazer, women's M'. Use all 5 hashtags/keywords that people really search (e.g. #vintage #90s #y2k #coquette #cottagecore #thrifted).
- **Description:** measurements (pit to pit, length, waist), fabric, condition, shipping time.
- **Pricing:** aim for $20-$30 average with a little room for offers. Make sure each item cost less than a third of its price.
- **Sell to likers:** use Depop's offer feature to give likers a small discount. Bundle: 'buy 2, save 15%' raises order size.
- **Cross-promote:** share new listings on Instagram Stories with a link sticker to the listing.
- **Do the math:** 10 sales/month = about 2-3 sales per week = list 5-7 items/week.

Goal 2: Custom dressmaking - first clients by Dec 1

- **Make it easy to say yes:** a menu with 3 options - (1) alterations/hemming from $15-$30, (2) simple custom dress/skirt from about $100, (3) premium special occasion (quoted). Always include a deposit.
- **Warm audience first:** friends, family, coworkers, school/church/mom groups, neighbors, wedding and event guests. Text them personally: 'I'm taking 3 custom dress orders for the holidays - want to see my sketches?'
- **Hook:** holiday parties, NYE, engagement photos, bridesmaids, graduation, birthdays, vacation.
- **Local channels:** Facebook community groups, Nextdoor, local mom groups, Instagram local hashtags (#[yourcity]weddings), Etsy-style listing with custom order template.
- **Proof:** before/after photos, process Reels, fabric swatch carousels, a 'dress of the week' sketch.

- **Process:** consult (15 min), measurements, 50% deposit, fitting, final payment. Put timelines in writing.

Goal 3: Personal styling - 1 client by Dec 31 ($150)

- **Package idea:** '90-minute Closet Edit + 10-look Lookbook' (virtual or in person) for $150. Optional add-on: shopping list or thrift trip.
- **Warm-start:** offer a free 10-minute 'style mini-consult' to 5 friends/week. 1-in-5 will usually convert.
- **Best audiences:** new moms, career changers, people with a big event, people moving, newly engaged, anyone with a messy closet.
- **Pitch lines:** 'New year, new closet', 'Holiday outfits planned for you', 'Never stare at your closet again'.
- **Proof:** style your husband, a friend or yourself in 3 different looks; post a Before/After; ask for 1 free test-client in exchange for a testimonial (then charge from the next client).

6. Instagram Content Plan

Post 5 days a week, plus daily Stories. Mix of 40% vintage, 30% dressmaking, 20% styling, 10% personal brand.

Day	Post type	Idea
Mon	Reel	'Thrift haul with me': what I bought and what I'll resell (and why).
Tue	Carousel	'New on Depop' - 5 best items with price and size + link in bio.
Wed	Reel	Dressmaking process: fabric to finished dress in 15 seconds.
Thu	Reel / Story	Styling tip: '3 ways to wear one vintage piece.'
Fri	Story + Post	Feature 'sale of the day' and bundle deal; share a customer review.
Sat	Reel	Behind the scenes: packing orders, photographing, sketching.
Sun	Story	Q&A; / poll: 'Which dress should I make next?'

30 content ideas to rotate

Vintage	Dressmaking	Styling
Thrift haul	Sketch to finished dress	Capsule wardrobe in 5 pieces
How I price vintage	Fabric choice: 3 options	Closet edit before/after
How to spot real vintage tags	Fit check / measuring	Outfit formula: 1 piece 3 ways
Before/after: cleaning a find	Time-lapse sewing	What to wear to holiday parties
Packing an order (ASMR)	Before/after alteration	Colors for your skin tone
Day in the life of a reseller	Dress of the week	Style quiz in Stories
Item story: where it came from	Client dress reveal (with permission)	'Style my husband' series
'Rate my find'	'Which color?' poll	Thrift-to-outfit challenge
Worn photo fits (try-on)	Mistakes I fixed	Mistakes people make with fit
What sold this week	Holiday order deadline reminder	Behind the scenes of a consult

Caption formula & hashtags

- **Hook** (first line grabs attention) + **value/story** + **call to action** ('DM DRESS for custom orders', 'Link in bio to shop').
- Use 5-10 targeted hashtags: a mix of niche (#vintagedresses #customdress #closetedit), local (#[city]style) and broad (#thrifted #sustainablefashion).

- Pin 3 posts: Best vintage, dressmaking work, styling pitch. Update the bio and add highlights: Shop, Custom, Styling, Reviews.
- Sunglasses teaser (1 post/month): 'Something new coming June 2027'. Build an email/DM list ahead of time.

DM / text templates

- **Dress:** 'Hi [name]! I'm taking 3 custom dress orders before the holidays, designed around you and your measurements. Want me to send ideas/pricing?'
- **Styling:** 'I'm opening a few spots for a closet edit + outfit lookbook this month. Want a free 10-minute mini consult to see if it's a fit?'
- **Depop liker:** 'Hi! I noticed you liked [item]. I can do [X%] off if you grab it today - and bundle with anything else for 15% off.'
- **Follow-up (3 days later):** 'Just checking in - no pressure! I have 2 spots left for December if you're interested.'

7. Where the Husband Can Help

- Photograph and film items on weekends (second pair of hands for worn-photos and Reels).
- Be the 'model' for styling content and mannequin shots.
- Help build her contact list: friends, family, coworkers who might want a dress or styling session.
- Pack and ship orders, run post office trips, keep receipts for expenses.
- Weekly 20-minute Sunday check-in: review the scorecard together and set next week's targets.
- Make personal introductions: 'My wife makes custom dresses - want me to connect you?'

8. Weekly Scorecard

Fill in every Sunday. If a number is behind two weeks in a row, change the tactic (price, photos, offer, audience) rather than just working harder.

Metric	Weekly target	Wk1	Wk2	Wk3	Wk4
New Depop listings	5-7				
Depop sales	2-3				
Instagram posts	5				
Outreach messages sent	20+				
Dress consults booked	1-2				
Styling mini consults	1-2				
Revenue this week	Pace to $650				

Weekly calendar (12 weeks)

Weeks	Dates	Main focus
1-3	Oct 12 - Nov 1	Setup, menu, 25 listings, 30 personal messages, first sales
4-7	Nov 2 - Nov 29	Dress deadline push, styling mini consults, 10 sales
8	Nov 30 - Dec 6	Dec 1 dress deadline: 3 clients locked in with deposits

Weeks	Dates	Main focus
9-11	Dec 7 - Dec 27	Make dresses, shipping deadlines, close styling client, 10 sales
12	Dec 28 - 31	Wrap up, collect reviews, plan Q1 + sunglasses teaser

If she falls behind

- Short on vintage sales: lower prices 10%, bundle, add worn photos, post on Instagram Stories daily.
- Short on dress clients: drop price on the first order, accept alterations/hemming to get started, and ask for referrals.
- Short on styling: offer a lower-priced 'mini' ($75) session and an upgrade; ask a friend to be the case study.
- Remember: even getting 2 of 3 goals is a strong first quarter. Keep notes on what worked.